# Group Health Insurance Plan & Benefits Guide

Policy Period 2026 **|** Coverage Limits, Co-Pay Terms, Ancillary Benefits, and Claim Guidelines

## Section 1: Group Health Insurance Program (Policy #GHI-99201)

The organization provides comprehensive group health insurance coverage underwritten by BlueShield Corporate Health. Coverage begins on the employee's official date of hire, with options to extend benefits to legal spouses, domestic partners, and dependent children under age 26 during the annual open enrollment window or within 30 days of a qualifying life event (marriage, birth, adoption, loss of other coverage).

## Section 2: Coverage Tiers & Benefit Sub-Limits Matrix

Insurance benefits are structured into three distinct plan tiers based on employment category and grade:

| Coverage Tier | Sum Insured Cap | Maternity Sub-Limit | Network Co-Pay % | Room Rent Cap |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Tier 1 (Individual) | $10,000 / Year | $3,500 | 10% | $250 / Day |
| Tier 2 (Family Floater) | $25,000 / Year | $5,000 | 10% | $500 / Day |
| Tier 3 (Executive Plan) | $50,000 / Year | $8,000 | 0% (Nil) | Suite / Actuals |

## Section 3: Waiting Periods, Co-Pay Rules & Exclusions

- **Pre-existing Conditions:** Covered after a mandatory waiting period of 24 months of continuous coverage.
- **Non-Network Admissions:** Subject to a mandatory 20% co-payment by the insured employee.
- **Pre/Post Hospitalization:** Expenses covered for 30 days prior to admission and 60 days post-discharge.
- **Standard Exclusions:** Cosmetic procedures not medically necessary, self-inflicted injury, and treatment obtained outside the plan's recognized provider network without prior authorization.

## Section 4: Claim Settlement & Cashless Authorization Procedures

For planned hospitalizations at network facilities, pre-authorization must be submitted at least 72 hours prior to admission. For emergency admissions, notification must reach the Third-Party Administrator (TPA) helpdesk within 24 hours of hospitalization. Reimbursement claims for non-network treatment must be filed within 30 days of discharge with original itemized bills.

## Section 5: Dental, Vision & Employee Assistance Program (EAP)

- **Dental:** Annual coverage up to $1,500 USD for preventive and basic restorative care; orthodontic coverage capped at $1,000 USD lifetime for dependents under 18.
- **Vision:** Annual allowance of $250 USD toward eye exams, lenses, or frames.
- **EAP:** Confidential access to up to 6 counseling sessions per issue per year, covering mental health, financial planning, and legal consultation, at no cost to the employee and not visible to the employer.

## Section 6: Wellness Program & Preventive Care Incentives

**Annual Wellness Incentive:** Employees who complete an annual preventive health screening and the wellness portal risk assessment qualify for a $200 USD reduction in their annual health-plan contribution, credited each January following the prior year's completion.

## Section 7: Life & Accidental Death Insurance

Every full-time employee is automatically enrolled in Group Term Life Insurance at 3x annual base salary (minimum $50,000 USD) at no cost to the employee, alongside Accidental Death & Dismemberment (AD&D;) coverage at an equivalent sum insured. Employees may purchase Voluntary Supplemental Life Insurance for themselves or dependents at group rates through the annual open enrollment portal, up to 5x annual salary subject to evidence-of-insurability approval above 2x salary.

## Section 8: Continuation of Coverage After Separation (COBRA-Equivalent)

Employees who separate from the company, and their covered dependents, may elect to continue group health coverage at their own cost for up to 18 months following the last day of active coverage, or up to 36 months for dependents losing eligibility due to divorce or the employee's death. Election must be made within 60 days of the qualifying event using the continuation election form provided by HR at separation.

## Section 9: Annual Open Enrollment & Mid-Year Plan Changes

Open enrollment runs each year from November 1 to November 20, with elections effective January 1. Outside this window, plan changes (adding a dependent, switching coverage tier, or dropping coverage) are permitted only within 30 days of a qualifying life event such as marriage, birth or adoption, divorce, or involuntary loss of other coverage, and must be filed with supporting documentation via the benefits portal.

## Section 10: Network Providers & Second Opinion Access

The plan's network includes over 8,000 hospitals and clinics nationally through the BlueShield Corporate Health directory, searchable via the benefits portal. For any diagnosis involving a major surgical procedure or a critical illness, employees may request a fully covered second medical opinion from a network specialist without a new referral, in addition to their treating physician's recommendation.

## Section 11: Grievance & Appeal of a Denied Claim

An employee whose claim is denied, in part or in full, may file a written appeal with the TPA within 30 days of the denial notice, supported by any additional medical documentation. The TPA must issue a decision on the appeal within 15 business days for standard claims and within 72 hours for urgent claims involving ongoing treatment. If the appeal is denied, the employee may request a final independent medical review at no cost, coordinated by the People Benefits team.

## Section 12: International Travel & Expatriate Medical Coverage

Employees traveling internationally on company business are automatically covered under the Global Travel Medical Insurance rider for the duration of the trip, including emergency evacuation and repatriation coverage up to $250,000 USD, at no cost to the employee and with no interaction required with the base group health plan. Expatriate employees on a long-term international assignment (90+ days) are instead moved onto the dedicated Expatriate Health Plan, coordinated by Global Mobility, which mirrors the Executive Plan tier described in Section 2 regardless of the employee's home-country grade.

Employees should carry their digital insurance card, accessible via the benefits mobile app, whenever traveling, and should contact the 24/7 international assistance line before seeking treatment where medically feasible so that cashless arrangements can be made with the local provider.

## Section 13: Dependent Eligibility Verification & Fraud Prevention

During open enrollment and at the time a dependent is first added, the benefits team may request supporting documentation (marriage certificate, birth certificate, or adoption papers) to verify dependent eligibility. Employees are required to remove a dependent from coverage within 30 days of the dependent losing eligibility — for example, a spouse following divorce or a child aging out at 26 — and failure to do so may result in retroactive premium recovery and, in cases of deliberate misrepresentation, disciplinary action under the Code of Conduct.

Periodic dependent audits are conducted every 2 years across the full plan population, coordinated by the TPA, to keep the group risk pool accurate and to keep premium costs, which are partly borne by employees at higher coverage tiers, as low as possible for the whole workforce.